Visual Direction Scene Plan

Assignment: Foundations of Visual Direction for Video & Games
Assignment Type: Visual Direction / Pre-Storyboard Planning

Submitted by: Mariam Abbas
Note: Extended to a 9-shot version.

Scene Title

"The Golden Crack"

Pip's Public Service Message Scene



Public Service Message

“Don’t give up on what seems broken. Every scar tells a story of resilience. With care, compassion, and love, what once seemed damaged can become something beautiful again—filled with strength, hope, and new beginnings.”

Scene Summary

Pip, an 87-year-old porcelain teapot, is accidentally cracked and replaced, leaving her forgotten in a dusty attic where she believes she has lost her worth. As the family's

beloved tea shop struggles to survive, Pip chooses courage over fear and returns to help despite her fragile condition. Her kindness and selfless service bring warmth back to the community, giving the tea shop a new chance to thrive. Inspired by her resilience, the grandmother repairs Pip's crack with gold using the art of kintsugi, celebrating her scars rather than hiding them. In the end, Pip returns home with pride, her golden crack and the green sprout beside her becoming lasting symbols of resilience, hope, and new beginnings.

Scene Details

Element	Description
Location	A cozy family kitchen, a dusty attic storage box, and a small family-run tea shop downstairs.
Main Character	Pip, an 87-year-old porcelain teapot with a visible crack after years of faithful service.
Social Problem	Objects—and by extension, people—that become damaged, old, or different are often considered worthless and discarded instead of being valued for their history, resilience, and experience.
Character's Goal	To rediscover her purpose and earn acceptance despite her visible flaw.
Conflict / Challenge	Pip believes her crack makes her useless. To help the struggling tea shop, she must overcome her fear of breaking completely and risk further damage.
Positive Action	Despite her fear and physical pain, Pip courageously helps the struggling tea shop family by pouring tea when they need hope the most, proving that her worth lies in her kindness and resilience.
Change at the End	Pip's crack is repaired with gold instead of being hidden, transforming it into a symbol of strength. She is celebrated rather than discarded, returns to a place where she belongs, and a small green sprout beside her represents hope, renewal, and new beginnings.

9-Shot Direction Plan

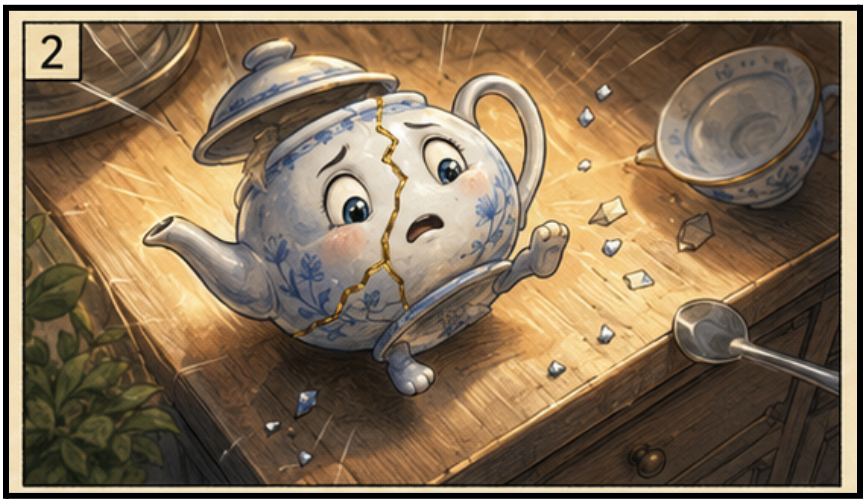
Shot 1 – Wide Shot (WS) **Pip Belongs**

Element	Description
Composition	Pip is positioned using the Rule of Thirds, with kitchen items in the foreground, Pip in the midground, and morning sunlight through the background window. The layered composition creates depth and shows that Pip belongs in this warm family environment.
Camera Angle	**Eye Level**. The audience views Pip as an equal, reinforcing that she is respected, valued, and an important part of the household before the conflict begins.
Camera Movement	**Static.** The still camera creates a calm, peaceful atmosphere and establishes the family's daily routine.
Lighting Mood	**High-Key Lighting**. Warm, natural morning light creates a bright, welcoming, and comfortable mood.
Audience Focus	Pip's cheerful expression and the gentle steam rising from her spout as she prepares the family's tea.
Audience Feeling	Warmth, comfort, familiarity, and a sense of belonging.
Story Message	This shot introduces Pip as a treasured member of the family, creating an emotional connection before the story's conflict unfolds.



Shot 2 – Medium Shot (MS) **The Crack**

Element	Description
Composition	Pip fills most of the frame as she slips from the shelf. Tight framing and negative space above her emphasize the sudden fall and draw attention to the moment of impact.
Camera Angle	**High Angle**. Looking down on Pip makes her appear small, vulnerable, and powerless as she loses control.
Camera Movement	**Handheld Shake.** A brief, sudden shake at the moment of impact heightens the sense of chaos and immerses the audience in the accident.
Lighting Mood	**Hard Lighting**.A sharp overhead light highlights the crack as it forms, emphasizing the severity of the damage.
Audience Focus	The exact moment the crack spreads across Pip's porcelain body.
Audience Feeling	Shock, sadness, and a sense of sudden loss.
Story Message	This shot presents the inciting incident that changes Pip's life forever, marking the beginning of her emotional journey.



Shot 3 – Wide Shot (WS) **Forgotten in the Attic**

Element	Description
Composition	Pip is placed low in the frame using the Rule of Thirds, surrounded by dusty boxes and cobwebs that create extensive negative space. Cobwebs occupy the foreground, Pip sits in the midground, and a faint beam of light filters through the floorboards in the background, emphasizing her isolation.
Camera Angle	**High Angle**.Looking down on Pip makes her appear small, forgotten, and vulnerable.
Camera Movement	**Static**.The motionless camera reinforces Pip's feeling of being trapped, abandoned, and unable to change her situation.
Lighting Mood	**Low-Key Lighting.**Dim, cool blue moonlight and deep shadows create a lonely, cold, and neglected atmosphere.
Audience Focus	Pip's small, cracked figure sitting alone among old, discarded objects.
Audience Feeling	Sympathy, sadness, loneliness.
Story Message	This shot highlights the story's social issue: objects—and people—that become damaged are often forgotten and discarded instead of being valued for their resilience and worth.



Shot 4 – Medium Shot (MS) **Choosing Courage**

Element	Description
Composition	Pip occupies the left third of the frame, with looking room toward the doorway she is moving toward. The foreground and midground separation emphasizes her small size against the large doorway, highlighting the challenge ahead.
Camera Angle	**Low Angle**. Viewing Pip from below makes her appear stronger and more courageous, emphasizing the bravery of her decision.
Camera Movement	**Slow Tracking Shot**.The camera follows Pip's slow, determined movement toward the doorway, allowing the audience to experience her struggle alongside her.
Lighting Mood	**Hard Lighting**.Dramatic red-orange light casts sharp shadows, visually expressing Pip's physical effort, pain, and determination.
Audience Focus	Pip's strained expression and the golden-tinted steam escaping through her crack as she continues to pour tea.
Audience Feeling	Tension, concern, admiration, and hope as Pip chooses courage over fear.
Story Message	This shot represents the story's positive action. Despite her pain and fear, Pip chooses to help others, proving that true worth comes from kindness, courage, and selflessness.



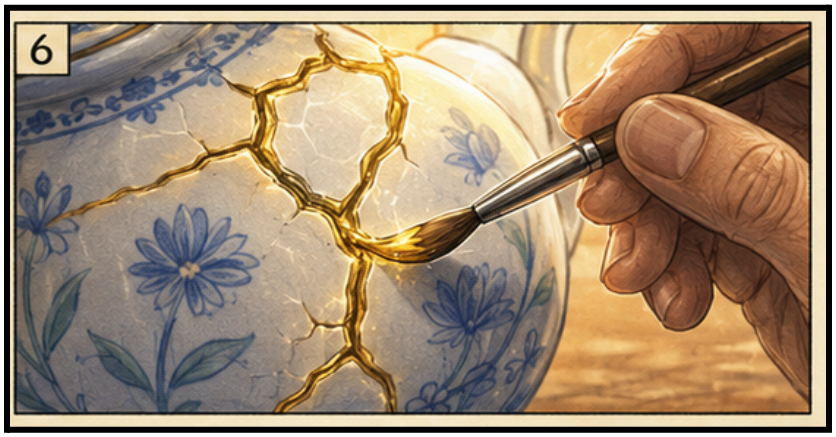
Shot 5 – Medium Shot (MS) **Seen with Compassion**

Element	Description
Composition	Using the Rule of Thirds, Pip and the grandmother are positioned together in the frame, while the worried tea shop family remains in the background. The grandmother's hands occupy the foreground, Pip is in the midground, and the family's hopeful faces create depth in the background.
Camera Angle	**Eye Level.** The camera places Pip and the grandmother on equal footing, emphasizing understanding, respect, and emotional connection rather than sympathy.
Camera Movement	**Static**.The still camera allows the audience to focus on the grandmother's emotional reaction without distraction.
Lighting Mood	**Soft Lighting.**Warm, gentle light creates a comforting atmosphere, symbolizing safety, acceptance, and compassion.
Audience Focus	The grandmother's expression softens as she notices Pip's crack and recognizes her courage.
Audience Feeling	Warmth, relief, hope,and reassurance.
Story Message	This shot marks the story's turning point. For the first time, someone sees Pip's flaw with compassion instead of judgment, recognizing her true value beyond her appearance.



Shot 6 – Close-Up (CU) **Gold Repair**

Element	Description
Composition	A macro close-up frames Pip's crack, filling most of the image with minimal negative space so the audience's attention remains on the delicate repair process.
Camera Angle	**Eye Level.** A straight-on view allows the audience to closely observe the transformation without distraction or bias.
Camera Movement	**Slow Zoom In.**The gradual zoom draws the audience's attention to the gold as it carefully fills the crack, emphasizing the significance of the repair.
Lighting Mood	**Back Lighting**.A warm glow behind the liquid gold makes it shimmer, creating a sense of beauty, hope, and transformation.
Audience Focus	The liquid gold slowly fills the crack, line by line, transforming it into a feature of beauty rather than a flaw.
Audience Feeling	Quiet wonder, tenderness, hope, and appreciation.
Story Message	This shot visually represents the core message of the story: damage is not erased or hidden but repaired with care, becoming a symbol of strength and resilience.



Shot 7 – Close-Up (CU) **Pip Accepts Herself**

Element	Description
Composition	A tight close-up frames Pip's face, with balanced headroom above and slight negative space to one side, allowing her emotions to stand out. Using the Rule of Thirds, her eyes are positioned along the upper third line to naturally draw the audience's attention.
Camera Angle	**Eye Level.** The camera remains at Pip's eye level, creating an intimate connection between her and the audience.
Camera Movement	**Static.** The still camera holds on Pip's changing expression, allowing the audience to fully experience her emotional transformation.
Lighting Mood	**High-Key Lighting.** Bright, soft, and even lighting creates a joyful atmosphere, symbolizing hope, healing, and acceptance.
Audience Focus	Pip's tearful smile and her beautifully repaired golden crack.
Audience Feeling	Joy, relief, acceptance, inspiration, and emotional satisfaction.
Story Message	This shot represents the story's resolution. Pip realizes that her crack is no longer a source of shame but a symbol of her resilience, courage, and unique journey.



Shot 8 – Wide Shot (WS) The Shop Comes Alive

Element	Description
Composition	Pip stands near the center of the frame using the Rule of Thirds, with the thriving tea shop visible around her. The counter occupies the foreground, Pip stands confidently in the midground, and happy customers enjoying tea fill the background, creating depth and a strong sense of community.
Camera Angle	**Eye Level (Slightly Low).** The slightly low eye-level angle gives Pip a quiet sense of dignity, confidence, and pride without making her appear overpowering.
Camera Movement	**Slow Dolly Out.** The camera gradually moves backward, revealing the lively tea shop and showing how Pip's actions have positively influenced those around her.
Lighting Mood	**High-Key Lighting.** Bright, warm sunlight fills the scene, creating an atmosphere of happiness, hope, and celebration.
Audience Focus	Pip's golden crack reflects the light and the small green sprout growing at her feet, symbolizing her transformation and renewal.
Audience Feeling	Hope, satisfaction, joy, and a sense of renewal.
Story Message	This shot shows the visible outcome of Pip's transformation. Her courage and acceptance have not only changed her life but have also brought new hope and happiness to the tea shop and its community.



Shot 9 – Close-Up (CU) **Direct Public Message**

Element	Description
Composition	Pip is centered in the frame, looking directly at the camera, with balanced negative space on both sides to create a clean composition that allows room for the closing message.
Camera Angle	**Eye Level.** A straight-on angle creates a direct, personal connection, making the audience feel as though Pip is speaking to them.
Camera Movement	**Static.** The camera remains steady while the final on-screen message appears, allowing the audience to focus on both Pip and the message.
Lighting Mood	**Soft Lighting.** Gentle, even lighting creates a sincere, comforting, and reflective atmosphere.
Audience Focus	Pip's calm, confident expression, followed by the public service message displayed beside her.
Audience Feeling	Reflection, warmth, encouragement, and a personal sense of hope.
Story Message	This final shot delivers the public service message directly to the audience: ***"What makes us feel broken is often what makes us most worth keeping."*** It reinforces the film's central theme that imperfections can become symbols of strength, resilience, and value.



Transition Idea

Element	Description
Selected Transition	**Dissolve**
Reason for Selection	A dissolve slowly blends the emotional close-up in **Shot 7** into the final resolution of **Shots 8 and 9**. This gradual transition reflects the gentle process of healing and acceptance rather than a sudden or jarring change. It visually reinforces the story's central message that Pip has not become a different teapot—she is the same character whose visible crack is now seen as a symbol of strength instead of shame. The dissolve also gives the audience a brief moment to absorb Pip's emotional transformation before the final public service message appears on screen, creating a smooth and meaningful conclusion.
	Fade (End of Shot 9)
	A fade to black/white is ideal for closing the film. It lets the final public service message linger on screen a little longer, giving the audience a quiet moment to reflect before the story ends. This calm, gradual fade-out matches the film's peaceful tone, leaving viewers with a lasting sense of hope rather than an abrupt stop.

Movement – The dissolve blends the shots slowly, matching Pip's slow, gentle healing instead of a sudden change.

Sound – If soft music plays through the dissolve, it makes the mood feel calm and connected, not abrupt.

Emotion – The blending shows Pip's feelings smoothly shifting from acceptance to joy, giving the audience time to feel it too.

Story Progress – It shows Pip's journey moving forward gently, from personal healing to a happy, shared ending, without breaking the emotional flow.

Together, the dissolve carries the audience gently through Pip's emotional journey, while the fade brings the story to a soft, thoughtful close, making the ending feel complete, calm, and emotionally resonant.